India's Counter Revolution

How the Xenie Cube Is Building Intelligent Commerce From the Kirana Up

As India Today chronicles five decades of India's evolution - from license-raj to liberalization to digital India - Sajid Jamal founder BranchX is quietly architecting the nation's next big leap: turning 13 million retail counters into AI-powered intelligence hubs.



Sajid Jamal
Founder–MD, BranchX

Sajid's journey began far from India's retail lanes. Growing up in the UAE, where his father served at the Sharjah Petroleum Council, he often heard stories of migrant workers'stories of hardship that later echoed in India's domestic migrant crisis. Witnessing people rely on informal money channels shaped his mission: to build ethical, accessible, intelligent financial infrastructure for the underserved.

After four decades in finance across Amoco Sharjah (later BP) and UAE's Investbank as Senior Credit Manager, Sajid returned to India, landing in an empty Noida flat days before the COVID lockdown. Survival depended on a young kirana retailer, Ankush Jain, who kept neighbourhoods fed despite collapsed supply chains and cash-flow strain. One insight from Ankush changed everything:

"If I knew exactly what my daily customers needed in real time, I'd never run out and never lose their trust."

That gap, POS machines that accepted payments but offered no intelligence, sparked the idea for Xenie Cube.

THE XENIE CUBE: A THINKING COUNTER

The Xenie Cube transforms any retail counter into an intelligent operating ecosystem equipped with Vision AI for counter governance, Voice AI for customer interaction, automated KYC and compliance, real-time retail analytics, POS payments plus supply chain credit intelligence, utility payments, and retail ad-tech tools.

"This isn't a device," Sajid says. "It's an operating system for India's 13 million offline retailers."

After years of deep R&D across hardware, sensors, AI, and retail workflows, BranchX has hit its scale-up inflection point. The mission now shifts to manufacturing, distribution, and nationwide rollout.

THE RAMU KAKA ANALOGY: INTELLIGENCE THAT REMEMBERS

Sajid compares the Xenie Cube to the beloved "Ramu kaka" of old Indian shops, the trusted second man who knew every customer's preferences, every pending payment, every distributor cycle. "The Xenie Cube becomes Ramu kaka's replacement," Sajid explains. "It intelligently automates stock, payments, and orders while reducing distributor costs through real-time insights."

Just as Ramu kaka would remember that Mrs. Sharma buys low-fat milk every Tuesday, the Xenie Cube's AI